

Atlas CRM 8.4 Administrator Guide

About this guide

This guide is for the administrators of an Atlas CRM account. It explains how to manage users and roles, configure pipelines, import and clean up contacts, set up forecasts, connect single sign-on, and solve the problems administrators report most often. It describes Atlas CRM 8.4; where version 8.4.1 changed something, the guide says so.

Administrators are the users with the Administrator role. Every account has at least one; the person who created the account is its first administrator and the account owner.

Users and seats

Each user occupies one seat. The number of seats is part of your plan: Basic includes 5 seats, Professional 25, and Enterprise any number agreed in the contract. Additional seats on Basic and Professional are billed monthly at the price of the plan, prorated to the day.

To invite a user, open Settings > Users > Invite and enter one or more e-mail addresses. The invitation link is valid for 7 days. Users who have not accepted appear with the status Invited and already occupy a seat; cancel the invitation to free it.

Deactivating a user frees the seat at once. The user can no longer sign in, but their contacts, deals, and activities stay in the account and can be reassigned under Settings > Users > Reassign records. Deleting a user is possible only after all their records have been reassigned.

Roles and permissions

Every user has exactly one role. The built-in roles are Viewer, Sales, Billing, and Administrator. Viewers can see but not change records. Sales users manage contacts and deals. Billing users see invoices, payment methods, and subscriptions, and nothing else. Administrators can do everything, including managing users and settings.

Enterprise accounts can also create custom roles, up to 20 per account, under Settings > Roles > New role. A custom role starts as a copy of a built-in role; you then switch individual permissions on or off. Changes to a role apply to its users at their next sign-in.

A common request is to give an accountant access to invoices without access to customer data. Use the Billing role: it shows invoices, receipts, and payment methods, but no contacts or deals.

Pipelines and stages

A pipeline is the sequence of stages a deal goes through, from first contact to won or lost. Every account starts with one pipeline, Sales, with six stages. Professional accounts can create up to 5 pipelines, Enterprise accounts up to 50. A pipeline can have at most 12 stages.

Each stage has a probability, from 0 to 100 percent, which weighted forecasts use. Set the probabilities under Pipeline settings > Stages. Changing a probability changes forecasts from that moment on; it does not change forecasts already saved.

Deals that stay in the same stage for 30 days without any activity are marked as rotting: their cards turn amber on the board. The number of days can be changed per pipeline, from 7 to 120.

The cards on the pipeline board show the deal name, the amount, the owner, and up to five fields of your choice under Pipeline settings > Card fields. In version 8.4.0, boards whose cards show many custom fields can stay on a loading spinner; version 8.4.1 fixes this. Until you upgrade, hide the custom fields you do not need on the board.

Importing contacts

The importer reads CSV and Excel files of up to 50,000 rows and 20 MB per file. Larger files must be split. The first row must contain column names; the importer suggests a field for each column, which you can change before you start.

The importer matches rows to existing contacts by e-mail address only. A row with an e-mail address that already exists updates that contact if you choose Update existing records; otherwise it is skipped. Rows without an e-mail address always create new contacts, which is the most common cause of duplicates after an import.

To clean up duplicates, use Contacts > Find duplicates. It compares names, e-mail addresses, and phone numbers, shows likely duplicates in groups, and lets you merge up to 100 groups at a time. Merging keeps the oldest record and moves the activities, deals, and notes of the others to it. A merge cannot be undone.

Forecasts

A forecast estimates the revenue you will close in a period: a month, a quarter, or a year. A simple forecast adds up the amounts of the open deals expected to close in the period. A weighted forecast multiplies each amount by the probability of the deal's stage first, which gives a more realistic figure.

Create a forecast under Forecasts > New forecast, choose the period, the pipelines, and the owners to include, and save it. Saved forecasts keep their numbers; at the end of the period, Atlas compares each forecast with the revenue actually closed and shows the difference as forecast accuracy.

Single sign-on

Enterprise accounts can sign in through an identity provider with SAML 2.0. Atlas has ready-made settings for Okta, Microsoft Entra ID, and Google Workspace; any other SAML 2.0 provider can be configured by hand under Settings > Security > Single sign-on.

When single sign-on is required, users can no longer sign in with an Atlas password, and password resets are handled by the identity provider. Keep at least one administrator who can sign in with a password, so that a mistake in the identity provider does not lock everyone out.

Audit log

The audit log under Settings > Security > Audit log records every sign-in, every change to users, roles, and settings, and every export of data, with the time, the user, and the IP address. Professional accounts keep 180 days of audit log; Enterprise accounts keep 2 years. The log can be exported as CSV.

Troubleshooting

Users cannot sign in: check whether their account is locked. After five failed attempts an account is locked for 15 minutes; administrators can unlock it at once under Settings > Users > Unlock. If your account uses single sign-on, the problem is usually in the identity provider.

The pipeline board does not load: see Pipelines and stages above. The problem affects version 8.4.0 only.

An import created duplicates: see Importing contacts above.